

- Edits the contents of the menu entries or creates new ones
- Changes menu visibility and timeout
- Changes the default boot entry
- Changes the GRUB resolution or background image
- Disables recovery entries
- Provides support for GRUB2/BURG
- Changes the kernel parameters, etc

To install Grub-customizer in Ubuntu and Mint, launch a terminal and type the following commands:

```
sudo add-apt-repository ppa:danielrichter2007/grub-customizer
sudo apt-get update
sudo apt-get install grub-customizer
```

Working with Boot-repair

Ever been stuck with an unbootable GRUB? Or been unable to access your multiple operating systems from the GRUB menu? That's when Boot-repair comes in handy. It is free software that is licensed under GNU GPL, and provides a graphical interface to repair frequent boot problems. Boot-repair allows the repair or recovery of your boot loader, gains access to the unbootable operating system and fixes issues when you install Windows after installing Linux. Boot-repair can be used either from a live CD or a Boot-repair disk, which automatically runs it at start-up. You can also install Boot-repair in your system if you have a bootable Linux.

Installing Boot-repair

There are two ways of installing Boot-repair.

By using the Boot-repair disk: The Boot-repair ISO image can be downloaded and burnt to a CD, or you can make it bootable on a live-USB using any of the USB bootable software available.

Installing in Ubuntu: Open a terminal and type the following commands:

```
sudo add-apt-repository ppa:yannubuntu/boot-repair
sudo apt-get update
sudo apt-get install -y boot-repair && boot-repair
```

Table 1: A comparison of boot loaders

Boot Loader	Can be installed via	Can boot from CD ROM	Supported file system	License
GNU GRUB	Linux or Bootable disk	Yes	EXT2/3/4, NTFS,FAT16/32	GPLv3
LILO	Linux	Yes	No specific file system	BSD License
BURG	Linux	Yes	-	GNU GPLv3
rEFInd	Linux	Yes	EXT2/4, NTFS	GPLv3/BSD License
SYSLINUX	Linux	Yes	-	GNU GPLv2 or Later

Using Boot-repair

Boot-repair offers the following options.

Recommended repair: Launch Boot-repair either from the *Applications* menu or from the terminal. The *Recommended repair* option allows you to solve the frequently occurring boot up issues. It reinstalls and repairs your default GRUB.

Advanced options: This option lets you delve more into GRUB and allows you to customise it the way you like.

Advanced options include:

- Re-installing GRUB and restoring MBR
- Backing up partition tables and boot sectors
- Repairing file system and Windows boot files
- Changing the GRUB location
- Purging GRUB
- Creating a boot information summary

Table 1 above gives a comparison of the different boot loaders. 

References

- [1] http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/GNU_GRUB
- [2] http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Comparison_of_boot_loaders
- [3] https://wiki.archlinux.org/index.php/Boot_loaders
- [4] <https://www.gnu.org/software/grub/manual/grub.html>

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